XIN (SOFIA) YUAN

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SUPERVISORS

Prof. Iman van Lelyveld
Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam
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Dr. T. Artiga Gonzalez
Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam & Tinbergen Institute
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EDUCATION

PhD Candidate in Finance 09/2022 – expected til 08/2027
Tinbergen Institute and Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam, Amsterdam, the Netherlands
Supervisors: I. and T.

Visiting PhD Student 01/2026 – 10/2026
Stockholm University, Stockholm, Sweden
Host: Gustav Martinsson

M.Sc. in Financial Econometrics 07/2019 – 08/2020
Johns Hopkins University, Washington, D.C., United States of America

B.A. in Finance and Russian Literature 09/2015 – 07/2019
University of International Business and Economics, Beijing, China

Exchange Semester (part of B.A.) 09/2017 – 12/2017
Southern Federal University, Rostov-on-Don, Russia

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Corporate Finance, Banking, Sustainable Finance, Corporate Governance, Financial Intermediation

JOB MARKET PAPER

Knowledge Without Control: Examination Delay and Green-Patent Acquisitions

Abstract: I study how delays in patent examination affect firms' purchases of green patents. I instrument the share of a firm's green applications still awaiting a first substantive office action eighteen months after filing with examiners' delay tendencies on other applicants' cases. Among firms facing product-market rivals filing in the same technology class, a one-standard-deviation increase in delay raises the probability of an acquisition in the following twelve months by 11.7 percentage points, against a base rate of 16.3%. The response is significantly stronger than among firms without such rivals. Evidence on the legal status and technological proximity of acquired patents is consistent with a legal-protection motive, although it does not rule out complementary knowledge acquisition. The findings show how patent examination and competitive exposure shape firms' demand for external patent rights.

WORKING PAPERS

Grouping the State: Reporting Boundaries and Exposure Concentration, with I.

Central Bank Reserves and Bank Stock Returns around ECB Decisions, with I.

Private Engagement, Public Votes: Evidence from Shareholder Engagement Disclosures, with T.

Green Patents as Collateral

CONFERENCES AND SUMMER SCHOOLS

Presentations

- 2026 Annual Meeting of the Swiss Society for Financial Market Research (SGF), Zurich, Switzerland
- 2025 International Risk Management Conference, Bari, Italy
- 2024 PhD Seminar, Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam, Amsterdam, The Netherlands

Summer Schools

- 2024: Finance and Product Markets: Theory, Evidence, and Measurements (*Laurent Fresard* and *Gordon Phillips*)

EXPERIENCE

De Nederlandsche Bank – Dutch Central Bank 07/2025 – now
Research Visitor *Amsterdam, Netherlands*

- Worked with bank-level supervisory data at the Dutch Central Bank (DNB), focusing on exposure concentration and banks' sensitivity to monetary policy. Processed large-exposure reports and reconciled differences in how banks grouped state-linked counterparties, assessing their implications for concentration measures and comparisons across banks. Linked supervisory balance-sheet data with high-frequency stock prices to evaluate how central-bank reserve holdings shaped bank equity responses to ECB policy surprises. Applied econometric methods to quantify these relationships and contributed to two working papers on banking supervision and monetary policy transmission.

Board Secretary at East Money Information Co., Ltd 04/2021 – 06/2022
Chief Officer Assistant *Shanghai, China*

- Contributed to the preparation of corporate disclosures and annual reports; supported investor communications and annual shareholder meetings; engaged in regular one-on-one meetings with major banks, facilitating the exchange of perspectives on industry trends and policy developments; acted as an intermediary by synthesizing insights across institutions in a context where direct peer communication was limited; liaised with fund companies' research and sales divisions; and supported strategic planning initiatives.

China Securities Co., Ltd 09/2020 – 11/2020
Internship in Financial Engineering Department *Shanghai, China*

- Applied machine learning and asset pricing models to develop quantitative investment strategies; conducted backtesting and valuation analysis; produced equity research reports with investment recommendations; engaged in investor roadshows to present research findings.

PUBLICATIONS

Green Gains: The Impact of REITs' Environmental Performance on Sustainability-Linked Loan Interest Rates, with Capera Romero, L. M., Artiga Gonzalez, T., Karmaziene, E.

SCHOLARSHIPS AND AWARDS

Research on Double Taxation Avoidance Laws in Kazakhstan (RMB 40,000) 2017 – 2019
with Dr. Yongmei Wang

Meritorious Winner in the Interdisciplinary Contest in Modeling (ICM) 2018

Integrated Third-Class Scholarship 2015 – 2018
University of International Business and Economics

Distinguished Academic Achievement Awards 2016 – 2017
University of International Business and Economics

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam

- Bachelor Thesis Supervision (number of theses: 55) 2022, 2023, 2024, 2025, 2026
- Finance (Undergraduate Level) 2022, 2023, 2024, 2025, 2026
- Corporate Finance: Theory and Empirics (Master Level) 2024
- Stochastic Processes: the Fundamentals (Master Level) 2025, 2026

Johns Hopkins University

- Financial Modeling and Valuation (Master Level) 2022

SKILLS

Languages	Chinese (*native*), English (*fluent*), French (*intermediate*), Russian (*intermediate*)
Computer Skills	Python, MATLAB, SQL, R, LaTeX, Stata, R programming, SPSS
Certificate	CFA Level 1